

INSTITUTION TYPE GUIDE

School Manual

Running a school, college, or training centre on the attendance system

School administrators and staff

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1. What a school account looks like

A school account tracks **students**, and optionally **teachers and staff**, by fingerprint. It is the only institution type with academic terms and year-end promotion.

Your sidebar has:

- **Attendance** — all scan records, filterable and exportable
- **Members** — your student roster (this may be renamed, see section 3)
- **Staff** — teachers and staff, if you track them
- **Academic** — terms, years, and holidays
- **Promotion** — year-end movement between grades
- **Devices, Enrollment, Accounts, Settings**

1.1 How a school day is recorded

A student places a finger on a scanner. The device recognises them, records the scan, and shows their name. Every night, the system fills in an **absent** record for every active student who did not scan that day — skipping holidays, and skipping weekends if you have that switch on.

This means your attendance register completes itself. You do not mark anybody absent by hand.

NOTE

Absences appear the following day, not immediately. If a student scans late in the evening after the nightly run, the system corrects their record from absent to present.

2. Setting up, in the right order

1. **Settings** — name, logo, timezone, and turn on **Skip weekends** if you do not run Saturday classes.
2. **Academic** — create the current term and mark it Active. Add your holidays.
3. **Devices** — assign each scanner to the grade and class it sits in.
4. **Members** — add students, or import them from a spreadsheet.
5. **Enrollment** — enrol each student's fingerprint.
6. **Accounts** — create logins for your admin and class teachers.

IMPORTANT

Create your academic term **before** the first scan. Every attendance record is tied to the term that was active when it happened. Scans taken with no active term are harder to report on later.

3. Terminology you can change

The system's default words are Member, Group, and Unit. Most schools rename them under **Settings** → **Custom labels**:

Default	A school usually calls it
Member / Members	Student / Students
Group	Form, Grade, or Year
Unit	Class, Stream, or Section
Period	Term or Semester
Staff	Teacher

Renaming changes the wording throughout the dashboard, including sidebar labels and CSV export headings. It changes nothing about the data itself, so you can adjust it at any time.

4. Academic terms and holidays

4.1 Terms

Go to **Academic** and add a period with its name, year, and start and end dates. Mark the current one **Active**.

Keep exactly one term active at a time. The active term is what the nightly absence run uses, and what most reports default to. At the end of a term, create the new one and mark it active — the old one becomes inactive automatically in effect, but check it.

4.2 Holidays

Add every non-teaching day here: mid-term breaks, public holidays, staff training days. No absences are generated for those dates.

Tick **Recurring** for holidays that land on the same calendar date every year, such as Independence Day. Do not tick it for dates that move, such as Easter — add those each year.

TIP

Enter next term's holidays at the same time as you create the term. A missed holiday means a full roster of false absences that somebody has to explain to parents.

5. Students

5.1 Adding students one at a time

Go to **Members**, press **Add member**, and fill in the ID number, full name, group, and unit.

5.2 Importing a whole class

Press **Import CSV** next to Add member.

1. Download the template.
2. Fill in one row per student — ID, full name, and unit.
3. Upload it. You get a preview showing which rows are ready and which have a problem, before anything is created.
4. Confirm.

Imported students start Inactive. That is deliberate: they have no fingerprint yet. Enrol each one, then set them Active. Only active students are included in the nightly absence run.

NOTE

If your unit column is rejected, check that the unit names in your spreadsheet exactly match the ones on your devices, including any custom label you set.

5.3 Leavers

Set a student to **Inactive** rather than deleting them. Their attendance history is preserved and stops generating absences. Deleting a student removes their records permanently and cannot be undone.

6. Year-end promotion

Promotion moves every active student up one group — Grade 9 to Grade 10, and so on. Students in the final year group are deactivated rather than promoted.

1. Go to **Promotion**.
2. Review the preview carefully. It shows exactly who moves and to where.
3. Press **Promote**.

IMPORTANT

Promotion is bulk and irreversible. **Export the full year's attendance before you run it**, and run it once, at the end of the academic year, after reports are done.

7. Teachers and class scoping

A teacher or staff account is read-only and sees only their own class. Assign the account to a unit when you create it under **Accounts** — that assignment is what limits what they can see, including in CSV exports.

Give class teachers a **teacher** account so they can check their own register without being able to change the roster.

8. Everyday problems

Problem	What to do
Whole class marked absent	A holiday was missing, or the device was offline all day. Add the holiday; check the device screen.

Problem	What to do
A student is absent but was in school	They did not scan, or scanned on a device outside their class. Check the device screen for "NO MATCH".
New student can't scan	Fingerprint not enrolled yet, or they are still Inactive.
Attendance not tied to a term	No term was active when the scan happened. Create and activate the term.
Teacher sees nothing	Their account has no unit assigned, or is assigned to the wrong one.
Import rejects rows	Missing field, or a unit name that does not match your devices.

9. Device quick reference

Screen shows	Meaning
Clock and device name	Normal, waiting for a scan
A name, then Present / Time In / Time Out	Scan recognised and recorded
A name and "Offline"	Recognised, but no internet — saved and will upload itself
"COOLDOWN" and a name	Same person scanned again within a minute. Normal.
"NO MATCH"	Finger not recognised. Try again.
A "queued" count under the clock	That many scans are waiting for the internet to return
"PENDING" and a MAC address	Device not yet assigned to a class
"OTA UPDATE" / "Do not unplug"	Installing an update. Leave it powered on.

Light	Meaning
Solid blue	Ready, online
Solid purple	Ready, but no WiFi
Green flash	Scan accepted
Red flash	Not recognised
Solid yellow	Waiting for a finger during enrollment
Breathing yellow	Waiting to be assigned
Breathing red	Installing an update — do not unplug

TIP

A device that has lost WiFi keeps working. It stores scans and uploads them when the connection returns, so a router outage never costs you a day's register.